

in carrying them around, just in case you need it. If it is not of use at that moment, it is almost certain that it will not be of use anytime soon.

Know your rights

As per the Reserve Bank of India, “If someone has fraudulently withdrawn money from your bank account, inform your bank immediately.

When you notify the bank, remember to take acknowledgement from your bank. The bank has to resolve your complaint within 90 days from the date of receipt.” This means that if you have lodged a timely complaint with the bank you use, with regards to any electronic financial frauds that you have fallen prey to, they are obligated to sort the issue out for you.

So never be afraid of losing your money. It is the duty of your bank to get it back for you, and to make that happen, the only thing that you have to do is report the incident swiftly and in a timely manner. If you do it, you are most probably going to get your money back.

But, if you delay informing the bank from your end, you will be one liable for your losses and will have to bear the loss on your own. This clause is written clearly on RBI’s website as: “If you delay the reporting, your loss will increase and it will be decided based on the RBI guidelines and the policy approved by your bank’s board.”

In case you are subjected to a financial fraud, there’s an RBI mandate that deals with such matters, and can be found at the following link:

<https://dgigit.in/rbilink>

The people have spoken

All the steps or preventive measures that we told you about, are not just something which came out of nowhere. The people have spoken. In a study published by Business Wire, titled, Indian Consumers More Concerned About Digital Payments Fraud Due to COVID-19 Compared To Last Year – New ACI Worldwide Study, it was told:

When asked about digital payments fraud via UPI or wallets, consumers cited the following as concerns:

- Fake UPI payment links that ask for money transfers via text or email (49 percent)
- Fake apps/fake websites which look authentic in design (47 percent)
- KYC update – where they receive fraudulent SMS or calls asking to update bank KYC (46 percent)